WILMINGTON DELAWARE STAKE RESOURCE GUIDE

Community Assistance

A Benefits and Basic Needs Resource Guide

Food · Cash Help · Health Coverage · Unemployment · Utilities
Housing · Disability · Seniors · Veterans · Tax Credits

Wilmington Delaware Stake
Cecil · Harford · Kent, Maryland
New Castle, Delaware · Lancaster · Chester, Pennsylvania
October 2026

> *Bear ye one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.*
> — Galatians 6:2

Federal, state and county help for unemployed and low-income households. Rules and amounts change — call to confirm.

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How to Use This Guide

This guide covers the six counties of the Wilmington Delaware Stake in three states. You use the programs of the state and county where you live — turn to your county's section. The one exception is unemployment, which you file in the state where you worked. Federal programs that work the same everywhere (Social Security disability, Medicare help, federal tax credits, Lifeline, VA) are explained once, in *Federal Benefits*.

If you live in	Main office to apply for food, cash and Medicaid	Online application	Help line
Cecil County, MD	Cecil County DSS, Elkton	MarylandBenefits.gov	2-1-1
Harford County, MD	Harford County DSS, Bel Air	MarylandBenefits.gov	2-1-1
Kent County, MD	Kent County DSS, Chestertown	MarylandBenefits.gov	2-1-1
New Castle County, DE	DHSS State Service Centers	assist.dhss.delaware.gov	2-1-1
Lancaster County, PA	Lancaster County Assistance Office	COMPASS (compass.state.pa.us)	2-1-1
Chester County, PA	Chester County Assistance Office	COMPASS (compass.state.pa.us)	2-1-1

Rules and dollar amounts are 2026 figures and change often — confirm with the agency before relying on a number.

First Steps for Anyone Who Just Lost Income

1. **File for unemployment the same week you stop working,** in the state where you worked. Benefits are not paid back to before you file.
2. **Apply for SNAP, Medicaid and cash help together** on your state's single application. Ask for expedited SNAP if you have little cash — it is issued within 7 days in every state.
3. **Call your utility and landlord before you fall behind,** and apply for energy assistance.
4. **Register with your county's job center** (American Job Center, Delaware JobLink or PA CareerLink) for job search and paid training. See the stake's *Finding Work* guide.
5. **Call 2-1-1** for food pantries, shelter and anything not listed here. It works in all three states.
6. **Talk with your bishop or ward self-reliance specialist.** They can help with immediate needs and work through a Self-Reliance Plan with you to map income, expenses and next steps.

About this guide. Compiled by volunteers of the Wilmington Delaware Stake as a free community service for anyone in Cecil, Harford and Kent counties (Maryland), New Castle County (Delaware), and Lancaster and Chester counties (Pennsylvania). It is not an official publication of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, and listing an organization is not an endorsement. It is not legal or financial advice and does not guarantee eligibility, benefits or services. Information was checked in October 2026, but programs, phone numbers, hours, dollar amounts and rules change often. Always call to confirm before you travel, apply or rely on any figure. Every program listed serves people of any faith or no faith.

Getting Ready to Apply

Most programs ask for the same papers. Having copies ready cuts weeks off a decision.

Documents to Gather

- Photo ID and Social Security numbers (or proof you applied) for everyone applying
- Proof of address: lease, mortgage statement or utility bill
- Pay stubs for the last 30 days, or your termination/separation letter
- Unemployment, Social Security, child support or pension award letters
- Rent, utility, child care and medical bills (these raise SNAP benefits)
- Bank statements and vehicle titles (some programs count assets)
- Immigration documents for any non-citizen applying
- Proof of disability or pregnancy, if it applies

2026 Income Limits at a Glance

Most programs set eligibility as a percentage of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which is the same in all three states. These are gross **monthly** amounts; each county section says which percentage its state uses for each program.

Household size	100% FPL	130%	138% (adult Medicaid, all 3 states)	150%	185% (WIC, reduced-price meals)	200% (SNAP in all 3 states)
1	$1,330	$1,729	$1,835	$1,995	$2,460	$2,660
2	$1,803	$2,344	$2,489	$2,705	$3,336	$3,607
3	$2,277	$2,960	$3,142	$3,415	$4,212	$4,553
4	$2,750	$3,575	$3,795	$4,125	$5,088	$5,500
5	$3,223	$4,190	$4,448	$4,835	$5,963	$6,447
6	$3,697	$4,806	$5,101	$5,545	$6,839	$7,393
7	$4,170	$5,421	$5,755	$6,255	$7,714	$8,340
8	$4,643	$6,036	$6,408	$6,965	$8,590	$9,287

Add $473/month at 100% FPL for each person beyond 8. Calculated from the 2026 HHS poverty guidelines ($15,960 for one person plus $5,680 per added person).

> **Help from the ward.** Applying for public programs is wise and appropriate. Bishops can also help with short-term food and essentials while applications are pending, and ward self-reliance specialists can help you build a household budget and Self-Reliance Plan.

Federal Benefits (Same in Every County)

These programs follow the same national rules in Maryland, Delaware and Pennsylvania. Each county section lists its local Social Security office and where to get help applying.

Social Security Disability: SSDI and SSI

SSDI pays people who worked and paid Social Security taxes. SSI pays up to $994/month (2026) to people with little income and under $2,000 in assets. You can apply for both at once.

	SSDI (Disability Insurance)	SSI (Supplemental Security Income)
Who	Workers with enough work credits — generally 40, with 20 in the last 10 years (fewer if younger)	Disabled, blind, or 65+ with low income and assets; no work history needed
Disability test	Cannot do substantial work for 12+ months, or condition expected to be fatal	Same medical test (children have their own)
2026 earnings limit (SGA)	$1,690/month ($2,830 if blind)	Same SGA for the disability decision; earnings also reduce the payment
Asset limit	None	$2,000 individual / $3,000 couple (home and one car excluded)
Payment	Based on your earnings record	Up to $994 individual / $1,491 couple
Waiting period	5 full months; first check for the 6th month	None — starts the month after you apply
Health coverage	Medicare after 24 months of benefits	Medicaid (automatic in MD, DE and PA)

How to apply

1. Gather records: every doctor, hospital and clinic with dates; medications; work history for the last 5 years; latest W-2 or tax return.
2. Apply online at ssa.gov/disability, by phone at 1-800-772-1213 (TTY 800-325-0778, Mon–Fri 8–7), or at your local Social Security office (listed in each county section; call ahead).
3. Answer every letter from your state’s Disability Determination Services and go to any exam they schedule.
4. Keep earnings under the SGA limit while your claim is pending.
5. Ask about Compassionate Allowances for severe diagnoses (certain cancers, ALS, early-onset Alzheimer’s) — these are fast-tracked.

If denied: request reconsideration within 60 days; then a hearing before an Administrative Law Judge (within 60 days of the next denial), where most approvals happen; then the

Appeals Council and federal court. Disability attorneys are paid only if you win, with fees capped by law. The 2027 cost-of-living increase is announced in mid-October 2026.

Medicare Help

Program	Pays	2026 monthly income limit (single / couple)
QMB	Part A & B premiums, deductibles, copays	$1,350 / $1,824
SLMB	Part B premium	$1,616 / $2,184
QI	Part B premium	$1,816 / $2,455
Extra Help (Part D)	Most prescription drug costs	About $1,995 / $2,705 (assets under $18,090 / $36,100)

Medicare Savings Program assets must be under $9,950 single / $14,910 couple. Apply for Medicare Savings Programs at your county's social services office; apply for Extra Help at ssa.gov. Free, unbiased Medicare counseling (SHIP in Maryland, the Delaware Medicare Assistance Bureau, PA MEDI in Pennsylvania) is listed in each county section.

New Federal Work Rules for SNAP and Medicaid

The 2025 federal budget law (H.R. 1) changed both programs in all three states.

- **SNAP time limit:** adults 18–64 without a child under 14 in the home get only 3 months of SNAP in 3 years unless they work, volunteer or train at least 20 hours a week (80 a month). Veterans, people experiencing homelessness and former foster youth are no longer exempt. Still exempt: people with a disability or medically unfit to work, pregnant women, caregivers of an incapacitated person, people in drug or alcohol treatment, and people receiving unemployment or cash assistance (state lists vary slightly).
- **Medicaid "community engagement" (starts January 1, 2027):** adults 19–64 covered through Medicaid expansion must show 80 hours a month of work, school, job training or volunteering (or equivalent earnings) and renew every 6 months. Exempt: pregnant and postpartum people, parents or caregivers of a child under 14 or a person with a disability, people with conditions that limit work, American Indians/Alaska Natives, disabled veterans, and people already meeting SNAP or cash-assistance work rules.
- Job center activities in each county section count toward both requirements.

Federal Tax Credits (2025 Tax Year, Filed in 2026)

Qualifying children	Maximum EITC	Income limit, single	Income limit, married filing jointly
0	$649	$19,104	$26,214
1	$4,328	$50,434	$57,554
2	$7,152	$57,310	$64,430
3 or more	$8,046	$61,555	$68,675

The Earned Income Tax Credit requires earned income (unemployment benefits do not count), a valid Social Security number and investment income of $11,950 or less; workers without children must be 25–64. The Child Tax Credit is $2,200 per child under 17, with up to $1,700 refundable if you earned at least $2,500. Maryland, Delaware and Pennsylvania each add a state credit (see county sections). Free tax preparation (VITA) is available for households under about $67,000 — call 2-1-1 in January.

Phone and Internet: Lifeline

Up to $9.25/month off phone or internet service if household income is at or below 135% FPL, or anyone in the household gets SNAP, Medicaid, SSI, federal public housing or Veterans Pension. Apply through the National Verifier (lifelinesupport.org) or 800-234-9473, then choose a participating company.

Veterans

VA Pension for wartime veterans 65+ or disabled with low income: maximum annual income $17,441 alone or $22,839 with one dependent, higher with Housebound ($21,313 / $26,710) or Aid & Attendance ($29,093 / $34,488); net worth limit $163,699. Medical expenses are deducted from income. **Veterans Crisis Line:** dial 988, press 1, or text 838255. Each county section lists the nearest VA medical center and free state help filing VA claims.

How the Three States Differ

The biggest differences across the region are in unemployment, cash help for adults without children, energy assistance limits and eviction timelines. Use this table to compare; each county section has the details and local offices.

Program	Maryland (Cecil, Harford, Kent)	Delaware (New Castle)	Pennsylvania (Lancaster, Chester)
Apply online for SNAP, cash, Medicaid	MarylandBenefits.gov	ASSIST (assist.dhss.delaware.gov)	COMPASS (compass.dhs.pa.gov)
Unemployment: weekly benefit	$50–$430, plus $8 per child under 16	$20–$450	$68–$605, plus up to $8 for dependents
Unemployment: length	Up to 26 weeks	Up to 26 weeks	18–26 weeks
Unemployment: minimum wages to qualify	$1,176.01 in one quarter and $1,800 across 2+ quarters	Wages in the base period (no dollar minimum published)	18 credit weeks; 37% of wages outside the high quarter
Unemployment: unpaid waiting week	None stated	None stated	Yes, first week unpaid
Unemployment: weekly work search	3 activities, at least 1 employer contact	At least 1 new contact or activity	2 job applications + 1 activity, from week 3
Unemployment: part-time earnings ignored	First $50 a week	$10 or 50% of weekly benefit, whichever is more	Up to 30% of weekly benefit
Unemployment: appeal deadline	15 days	10 days	21 days
SNAP gross income limit	200% FPL	200% FPL (165% for separate elderly/disabled households)	200% FPL
SNAP extra for seniors	$40 minimum for households with someone 62+	—	—
Cash for families (3 people, max per month)	TCA $773	TANF $405	TANF up to $421 (varies by county)
Cash time limit	60 months	Generally 36 months	60 months
Cash for adults without children	TDAP up to $348/month (disabled 3+ months)	General Assistance $79/month	None (ended 2019); SSI state supplement $22.10

Program	Maryland (Cecil, Harford, Kent)	Delaware (New Castle)	Pennsylvania (Lancaster, Chester)
Medicaid for adults	138% FPL	138% FPL	138% FPL
Children’s health coverage	MCHP to 322% FPL	Healthy Children Program to 212%	CHIP to 314% (free below 208%)
Private insurance marketplace	Maryland Health Connection (state young-adult subsidy)	HealthCare.gov	Pennie
Energy assistance income limit	200% FPL, year-round	60% of state median income; heating Oct–Mar, crisis year-round	150% FPL; opens November 2, 2026
Child care subsidy at entry	$94,026/year for 3 (waitlist; $1–$3 per child per week copay)	225% FPL	200% FPL
State earned income credit	45% of federal (with children), 100% (none); refundable	4.5% refundable or 20% non-refundable	10% of federal, up to $805
Renter / homeowner tax relief	Renters’ credit up to $1,000; Homeowners’ credit (income $60,000 or less)	Senior School Property Tax Credit (65+)	Property Tax/Rent Rebate $380–$1,000 (65+, widows 50+, disabled; income $48,110 or less)
Eviction notice for unpaid rent	10-day notice before filing	7-day notice before filing	10-day Notice to Quit
Free eviction lawyer	Access to Counsel (Maryland Legal Aid)	Right to counsel at or below 200% FPL	No statewide right; legal aid may help
Help line	2-1-1	2-1-1	2-1-1

FPL = Federal Poverty Level (see the income table in *Getting Ready to Apply*).

Living near a state line: you get food, cash, health and housing help from the state where you live, and file for unemployment in the state where you worked. Cecil Transit Routes 1, 2, 4 and 5 connect to Delaware and Harford County.

Cecil County, Maryland

Start at the **Cecil County Department of Social Services (DSS)**, 170 East Main Street, Elkton, MD 21921, 410-996-0100 (Mon–Fri 8:00–4:30). One application there or at MarylandBenefits.gov covers SNAP, cash assistance, Medicaid, emergency aid and energy help. This section also gives the full Maryland rules that apply in Harford and Kent counties.

Unemployment Insurance (Maryland)

Maryland pays $50 to $430 a week for up to 26 weeks.

- **Wages:** your base period is the first four of the last five completed calendar quarters (or the last four if that fails); you need at least $1,176.01 in one quarter and $1,800 total across at least two quarters.
- **Weekly benefit:** about 1/24 of wages in your best base-period quarter, plus $8 per child under 16 (up to 5), capped at $430.
- **Part-time work:** the first $50 earned each week is not deducted; each dollar above $50 cuts the benefit by a dollar. Severance is deducted; Social Security is not.

How to apply

1. File online at BEACON (beacon.labor.maryland.gov) or call 667-207-6520 the week your job ends.
2. Register in the Maryland Workforce Exchange (separate login) and post a résumé.
3. File a weekly claim every week (Sunday–Saturday) in BEACON or at 800-827-4839.
4. Do 3 work-search activities a week, at least 1 an employer contact, and log them in MWE.
5. Answer every notice and fact-finding call on time.

Reason for denial	Penalty
Quit without good cause	No benefits until rehired and you earn 15× your weekly benefit (5–10 weeks if “valid circumstances”)
Fired for simple misconduct	5–10 week delay
Fired for gross / aggravated misconduct	No benefits until you earn 25× / 30× your weekly benefit
Refused suitable work	No benefits until you earn 10× your weekly benefit (or 5–10 weeks)

Appeal within 15 days of the decision’s mailing date (Lower Appeals 410-767-2421) and keep filing weekly claims meanwhile. Employers cutting hours 10–60% can use Maryland Work Sharing so workers collect partial benefits.

Jobs and Training

Susquehanna Workforce Center – Elkton, 1275 West Pulaski Hwy, Elkton, 410-996-0550 (Mon–Fri 8:00–4:30) is the American Job Center. It offers free job search help and federally

funded (WIOA) training at little or no cost for unemployed, laid-off and low-income adults.

1. Register in the Maryland Workforce Exchange.
2. Attend a free JobQuest orientation.
3. Return the Customer Service Assessment Form.
4. Meet your Employment Specialist to build a training plan with an approved school.
5. Upload ID, work authorization and layoff or income proof to MWE.

Also: DORS (job help for people with disabilities), 101 Chesapeake Blvd, Suite D, Elkton, 410-996-0620; Cecil College free tuition up to 12 credits for SSDI/SSI recipients, 410-287-1000; Cecil County Public Library computers and résumé help, 301 Newark Ave, Elkton, 410-996-1055.

Food

SNAP (Maryland Food Supplement Program)

- Gross income up to 200% FPL with no asset test for most households. Net income after deductions (20% of earnings, $217 standard deduction, child care, medical costs over $35 for 60+/disabled, shelter up to $769) must generally be at or below 100% FPL.
- **Maximum monthly benefit (Oct 2026–Sep 2027):** 1 = $306, 2 = $562, 3 = $808, 4 = $1,023, 5 = $1,217, 6 = $1,463, 7 = $1,616, 8 = $1,841 (+$225 each extra). Maryland tops up households with a member 62+ to at least $40/month.
- Apply at MarylandBenefits.gov, at DSS, or by mail; a signed page with name and address starts the clock. **Expedited SNAP within 7 days** if cash is under $100 and income under $150 this month, or income plus cash is less than rent plus utilities. Complete the phone interview and send verifications; decision within 30 days.
- The federal 20-hours-a-week work rule (see *Federal Benefits*) has applied in Maryland since November 1, 2025; Cecil County has no waiver.

WIC: pregnant women, new mothers and children under 5 at or below 185% FPL. Cecil County WIC, 401 Bow St, Elkton, 410-996-5255.

Children: CCPS students approved for free or reduced-price meals pay $0 (apply through My School Apps; 410-996-5401). SUN Bucks gives $120 per child each summer, automatic for SNAP, TCA, Medicaid and free-meal households.

Seniors: home-delivered meals and weekday lunch at the Elkton Senior Activity Center, 410-996-5295 option 3; Senior Farmers Market coupons ($35/yr, 60+ at or below 185% FPL). The CSFP senior food box is not offered in Cecil.

Food pantry (call ahead)	Address	Phone	Hours
St. Mary Anne’s Episcopal	315 S Main St, North East	410-287-2230	Mon/Wed/Sat 9:30–12
Ray of Hope Mission Center	960 Craigtown Rd, Port Deposit	410-378-9800	Tue–Fri 9–4
Cecil County Help Center	135 E High St, Elkton	443-986-3548	Mon–Fri 9–11:45 and 1–3:15
Immaculate Conception Outreach	455 Bow St, Elkton	410-398-1100	Mon/Wed/Fri 9:30–11:30
MRDC Sheilagh’s Pantry	200 Road B, Elkton	410-287-1100 ext. 1125	Mon/Wed 2–4
Good Shepherd / St. Vincent de Paul	810 Aiken Ave, Perryville	410-642-3588	Every other Fri 10–11:30
Blythedale SDA Church	36 Blythedale Rd, Perryville	410-378-2356	Sun/Mon 10–12
Tabitha’s Pantry	1168 W. Old Philadelphia Rd, North East	443-907-5566	Call for hours

Cash Assistance

Program	Who	Amount and rules
Temporary Cash Assistance (TCA)	Families with a child under 18	Max monthly grant (Jan 2026): 1 = $348, 2 = $612, 3 = $773, 4 = $926, 5 = $1,074, 6 = $1,180. Income below the grant; no asset test; child support cooperation; work activities unless exempt; 60-month lifetime limit
Temporary Disability Assistance (TDAP)	Adults without children, disabled 3+ months	Up to $348/month; medical report required; 12 months in 36 unless an SSI claim is pending
Emergency Assistance to Families with Children	Families with a child under 21 facing eviction, shutoff, deposit, burial	Documented emergency; once every 24 months; subject to funds
Welfare Avoidance Grant	TCA-eligible families with one specific need	Lump sum instead of monthly TCA (ask your caseworker)

All through Cecil DSS, 410-996-0100.

Disability Supports

SSDI and SSI: see *Federal Benefits*; Elkton Social Security office, 300 Big Elk Mall (1-866-331-2218; Mon–Fri 9–4). Locally: TDAP while you wait; DORS job help (410-996-0620); Cecil County Aging & Disability Services for Community First Choice, the Community Options Waiver and in-home help, 410-996-5295 ext. 1.

Health Coverage and Care

- Maryland Medicaid covers adults to 138% FPL, pregnant people to 264% (12 months postpartum) and children to 322% (MCHP). Apply at marylandhealthconnection.gov or 1-855-642-8572. Coverage can reach back 3 months (1–2 months starting 2027).
- **Private plans:** open enrollment for 2027 starts November 1, 2026; Maryland adds a state subsidy for ages 18–37.
- **Medicare help:** Maryland Senior Prescription Drug Assistance Program, 1-800-551-5995; SHIP counseling, 410-996-8425.

Low-cost care	Contact
West Cecil Health Center (sliding fee)	49 Rock Springs Rd, Conowingo; also 401 Bow St, Elkton · 410-378-9696
Cecil County Health Department	401 Bow St, Elkton · 410-996-5550
ChristianaCare Union Hospital financial assistance (free to 400% FPL)	106 Bow St, Elkton · 410-392-7033
Upper Bay Counseling (mental health)	200 Booth St, Elkton · 410-996-3450
Crisis	988 · Eastern Shore Crisis Helpline 888-407-8018

Housing and Homelessness

- **Homeless or about to be:** Meeting Ground, 410-996-3096 — the county's single entry point; men's shelter and transitional housing for women and families. See the stake's *Emergency Housing* guide.
- **Housing Choice Vouchers:** Cecil County Housing Agency, 200 Chesapeake Blvd, Elkton, 410-996-5245. Income generally under 50% of area median (2026: $42,950 for 1, $49,100 for 2, $55,250 for 3, $61,350 for 4); county residents get preference; wait about 3 years. Elkton Housing Authority (public housing), 150 E Main St, 410-398-5018.
- **Eviction (Maryland law):** the landlord must send a 10-day notice before filing; go to court; get a free lawyer from Maryland Legal Aid, 1-888-465-2468; paying the full judgment before the sheriff arrives stops the eviction; only the sheriff can evict; late fees are capped at 5%. Emergency money: DSS Emergency Assistance and Eviction Assistance (410-996-0100); Immaculate Conception Outreach (410-398-1100).
- **Veterans:** Sheppard Pratt SSVF, 410-938-4357.

Utilities

Maryland energy assistance (OHEP) covers households up to 200% FPL, year-round: MEAP for heating fuel, EUSP for electric bills, and arrearage retirement up to $2,000 electric / $1,000 gas on past-due balances of $300+. Apply at MarylandBenefits.gov, 1-800-332-6347, or Cecil County Energy Assistance, 135 E High St, Elkton, 410-996-0270. Bring ID, Social Security cards, 30 days of income and your latest bills; reapply each July. Delmarva Power payment plans: 1-800-375-7117.

Children and Families

- **Child Care Scholarship (MSDE):** waitlist since May 2025, slots offered as space opens; TCA, SSI and homeless families go first. New applicants qualify with income up to $94,026 a year for a family of 3 or $111,936 for 4; copay is $1–$3 per child per week ($0 for families on TCA, SSI, SNAP or WIC).
- **Head Start (ages 3–4):** Maryland Rural Development Corp., 200 Road B, Elkton, 410-398-6638. Cecil's Early Head Start closed September 2, 2026.
- **Judy Center early learning hubs (ages 0–5):** 410-996-5082.
- **Child support:** Cecil DSS, 410-996-0100. If you lost your job, request a modification right away.

State and Local Tax Credits

Credit	Amount	Who
Maryland EITC	45% of federal EITC with children; 100% without; refundable	Anyone who gets the federal EITC
Maryland Child Tax Credit	$500 per child under 6 (or disabled under 17)	Federal AGI $15,000 or less
Renters' Tax Credit	Up to $1,000	60+, disabled, or with a child under 18; low income; apply by October 1
Homeowners' Property Tax Credit	Caps property tax by income	Income $60,000 or less; apply by October 1
Cecil County Senior Tax Credit	20% off county tax	65+ homeowners in the home 10+ years, household income under $150,000, assessed value up to $500,000; apply by September 1 (Finance 410-996-5385)

Seniors and Veterans

Program	Contact
Cecil County Aging & Disability Services	200 Chesapeake Blvd, Elkton · 410-996-5295 ext. 1
Maryland Access Point and SHIP Medicare counseling	410-996-8425
Elkton Senior Activity Center (lunch Mon–Thu)	200 Chesapeake Blvd, Suite 1700 · 410-996-5295 ext. 3
SOAR (help staying at home, 62+)	410-996-8425
MD Veteran Service Center (free VA claims help)	105 Chesapeake Blvd, Suite A (inside the MVA) · 667-225-6870
Perry Point VA Medical Center	361 Boiler House Rd, Perry Point · 410-642-2411
Elkton Vet Center (counseling)	103 Chesapeake Blvd · 877-927-8387
Maryland Veterans Trust Fund (emergency bills)	Apply online the 1st–15th of each month · 410-260-3838

Legal Help and Transportation

- Maryland Legal Aid (Cecil/Harford office), 103 S. Hickory Ave, Bel Air, 410-836-8202; intake 1-888-465-2468. Maryland Court Help Center, 410-260-1392. Maryland Volunteer Lawyers Service, 410-539-6800. See the stake's *Free Legal Help* guide.
- **Cecil Transit** (410-996-5295 option 2): routes to Glasgow and Newark DE, North East, Perryville MARC, Perry Point VA and Harford; $2 a ride ($1 reduced for 60+ and Medicare cardholders); door-to-door demand response; transportation reimbursement up to $350/yr. Medicaid rides: Health Department, 410-996-5171.

Cecil County Contacts

Need	Phone
SNAP, cash, Medicaid, child support (DSS)	410-996-0100
Energy assistance	410-996-0270
Unemployment	667-207-6520
Job center	410-996-0550
Housing vouchers	410-996-5245
Shelter (Meeting Ground)	410-996-3096
Seniors and disability services	410-996-5295
Health Department / WIC	410-996-5550 / 410-996-5255
Veterans	667-225-6870

Harford County, Maryland

Start at the **Harford County Department of Social Services**, 2 S Bond St, Suite 300, Bel Air, MD 21014, 410-836-4700 (Mon–Fri 8:00–4:30), or its field office at Swan Creek Village Center, 2029 Pulaski Hwy, Havre de Grace, 410-297-6100. Harford uses the same Maryland programs and rules as Cecil County; the key numbers are repeated here, and the Cecil section has the full detail.

Unemployment Insurance (Maryland)

- $50–$430 a week for up to 26 weeks, plus $8 per child under 16. Wages needed in at least two quarters of the base period.
- **Apply:** BEACON or 667-207-6520; register in the Maryland Workforce Exchange; file weekly; do 3 work-search activities a week.
- Appeal within 15 days. Quitting without good cause or misconduct can stop benefits (see the Cecil section table).

Jobs and Training

- **Susquehanna Workforce Center – Swan Creek,** 2129 Pulaski Hwy, Suite 101, Havre de Grace, 410-272-5400 (Mon–Fri 8:00–4:30): American Job Center with free job search help and WIOA-funded training. Steps: register in MWE, attend JobQuest, meet an Employment Specialist.
- **DORS Bel Air** (disability job services), 2 S Bond St, Suite 102, 410-836-7636.
- **Harford Community College:** tuition waiver for Maryland residents on SSI/SSDI (file a FAFSA each term) and for seniors 60+; no unemployment waiver. 443-412-2208.
- **Harford County Public Library,** Bel Air branch, 100 E Pennsylvania Ave, 410-638-3151 — computers and job help.

Food

- **SNAP:** gross income up to 200% FPL; same benefit amounts and rules as Cecil (max $306 for 1, $808 for 3, $1,023 for 4). Apply at MarylandBenefits.gov or DSS; ask for expedited 7-day SNAP.
- **WIC** (185% FPL; pregnant women, new mothers, children under 5): Swan Creek, 2027 Pulaski Hwy, Suite 107, Havre de Grace, 410-939-6680; Edgewood, 1321 Woodbridge Station Way, 410-612-1776; Bel Air, 1 N Main St, 410-638-3060 (appointment).
- **School meals:** free and reduced-price meals and SUN Bucks ($120/child each summer) work as in Cecil. HCPS main line 410-838-7300.
- **Senior meals:** Harford County Office on Aging, 410-638-3025.

Food pantry (call ahead)	Address	Phone	Hours
Harford Community Action Agency	1321 Woodbridge Station Way, Edgewood	410-612-9899	Mon–Fri 8–4:30
Epicenter Edgewood	1918 Pulaski Hwy, Edgewood	443-981-3742	Tue/Thu 10–2
Epicenter Aberdeen	21 Aberdeen Shopping Plaza	443-981-3742	Tue/Thu 11–1
Calvary Baptist	206 E Courtland Pl, Bel Air	410-838-6080	Mon 6–7 pm, Tue 9:30–3
First Presbyterian	224 N Main St, Bel Air	410-838-5777	Mon/Tue/Fri 9:30–10:30
St. Joan of Arc	222 S Law St, Aberdeen	410-272-4535 x3	Fri/Sat 9:30–11
St. John’s Cupboard	114 N Union Ave, Havre de Grace	667-201-0236	Wed 10–12
Trinity Lutheran	1100 Philadelphia Rd, Joppa	410-679-4000 x105	Tue 6–7:30 pm, Thu 3:30–5, Sat 10–12

Cash Assistance

Same Maryland programs as Cecil, through Harford DSS (410-836-4700): TCA for families with children (max $773/month for 3, $926 for 4); TDAP up to $348/month for adults without children disabled 3+ months; Emergency Assistance for families facing eviction or shutoff (once every 24 months).

Disability Supports

SSDI and SSI: see *Federal Benefits*. The Social Security office serving Harford is at 3435A Box Hill Corporate Center Dr, Abingdon (call 1-800-772-1213; there is no Bel Air office). Local help: TDAP; DORS Bel Air, 410-836-7636; Harford Office on Aging / Maryland Access Point for in-home and waiver services, 410-638-3025.

Health Coverage and Care

- Maryland Medicaid (adults 138% FPL, pregnant 264%, children 322%): marylandhealthconnection.gov or 1-855-642-8572. 2027 open enrollment starts November 1, 2026.

Low-cost care	Contact
Harford County Health Department	120 S Hays St, Suite 200, Bel Air · 410-877-2300
West Cecil Health Center (sliding fee; behavioral health)	253 Lewis Ln, Suite 202, Havre de Grace · 410-378-9696
Beacon Health Center (primary care)	253 Lewis Ln, Suite 201, Havre de Grace · 443-502-7060
UM Upper Chesapeake / Harford Memorial financial assistance	410-821-4140 or 877-632-4909
Klein Family Harford Crisis Center (walk-in 9 am–9 pm daily)	802 Baltimore Pike, Bel Air · 443-643-2422
24/7 crisis line and mobile crisis	1-800-639-8783 (1-800-NEXT-STEP) · 988

Housing and Homelessness

- **Homeless or facing eviction:** Harford Community Action Agency, 410-612-9909 ext. 2204 (1–4 pm) or 443-456-3629; after hours call 2-1-1. Landlord/tenant hotline 443-447-7336.
- **Anna's House** (Catholic Charities; families facing homelessness or abuse), 607 N Tollgate Rd, Bel Air, 667-600-2840.
- **Domestic violence:** SARC hotline 410-836-8430.
- **Housing Choice Vouchers:** Harford County Housing Agency, 15 S Main St, Bel Air, 410-638-3045 (also free housing counseling).

2026 income limits, Harford (annual)	30% AMI	50% AMI
1 person	$28,150	$46,900
2 people	$32,200	$53,600
3 people	$36,200	$60,300
4 people	$40,200	$67,000

- **Eviction:** same Maryland rules as Cecil (10-day notice, pay the full judgment to stay, sheriff only). Free lawyer: Maryland Legal Aid, 1-888-465-2468.

Utilities

Maryland energy assistance (MEAP, EUSP, arrearage help) to 200% FPL, year-round. In Harford, apply through Harford Community Action Agency, 1321-B Woodbridge Station Way, Edgewood, 410-612-9909 (Mon–Fri 8–5), at MarylandBenefits.gov, or 1-800-332-6347.

Children and Families

- **Child Care Scholarship:** same statewide waitlist rules as Cecil.

- **Head Start (ages 3–4):** Maryland Rural Development Corp., 1319 Woodbridge Station Way, Edgewood, 410-612-9001 x812.
- **Judy Centers:** Deerfield ES 410-612-1535; Hall's Cross Roads ES 410-273-5524; Magnolia ES 410-612-4237.
- **Child support:** 101 S Main St, Suites 102 & 200, Bel Air; 1-800-332-6347.

State and Local Tax Credits

Maryland EITC, Child Tax Credit, Renters' and Homeowners' credits: same as Cecil. **Harford County Senior Tax Credit:** 20% off county property tax for owners 65+ with a home assessed at $600,000 or less who have lived there 35+ years or are uniformed-services retirees (also veterans with a 50%+ service-connected disability); apply January 15–April 1; 410-638-3450.

Seniors and Veterans

Program	Contact
Harford County Office on Aging, Maryland Access Point and SHIP	145 N Hickory Ave, Bel Air · 410-638-3025
MD veterans benefits service office	501 W McPhail Rd, Bel Air (no walk-ins Wednesdays)
Perry Point VA Medical Center	410-642-2411
Maryland Veterans Trust Fund	410-260-3838

Legal Help and Transportation

- Maryland Legal Aid (Cecil/Harford office), Bel Air, 410-836-8202; intake 1-888-465-2468. Harford lawyer referral 410-836-0123. Circuit Court clerk, 20 W Courtland St, Bel Air, 410-638-3247. Maryland Court Help Center 410-260-1392.
- **Harford Transit LINK:** dispatch 410-612-1620 option 1. Reduced fare $0.50 for 60+, people with disabilities, and Medicare, SSDI or SSI recipients. Demand-response/paratransit $2 each way (book Mon–Fri 8–6).
- **Medicaid rides:** Health Department, 410-638-1671 (book 2 business days ahead).

Harford County Contacts

Need	Phone
SNAP, cash, Medicaid (DSS)	410-836-4700
Energy, eviction, shelter (HCAA)	410-612-9909
Unemployment	667-207-6520
Job center	410-272-5400
Housing vouchers	410-638-3045
Seniors	410-638-3025
Health Department	410-877-2300
Crisis	1-800-639-8783

Kent County, Maryland

Start at the **Kent County Department of Social Services**, 350 High St, Chestertown, MD 21620, 410-810-7600 (Mon–Fri 8:00–4:30). It handles SNAP, cash assistance, Medicaid help, energy assistance, emergency aid and shelter referrals. Kent uses the same Maryland programs and rules as Cecil County; the key numbers are repeated here, and the Cecil section has the full detail.

Unemployment Insurance (Maryland)

- $50–$430 a week for up to 26 weeks, plus $8 per child under 16.
- **Apply:** BEACON or 667-207-6520; register in the Maryland Workforce Exchange; file weekly; do 3 work-search activities a week. Appeal within 15 days.

Jobs and Training

- **Kent County American Job Center** (Upper Shore Workforce), 115A S. Lynchburg St, Chestertown, 410-778-3525; open Mondays and Fridays — call first. Free job search help and WIOA-funded training.
- **DORS** (disability job services): call DORS headquarters, 410-554-9442, for the counselor covering Kent.
- **Chesapeake College** (serves Kent County) Continuing Education & Workforce Training, 410-827-5850.
- **Kent County Public Library** (computers and job help): Chestertown, 408 High St, 410-778-3636; North County, 119 N. Main St, Galena, 410-648-5380; Rock Hall, 21258 Rock Hall Ave, 410-639-7162.

Food

- **SNAP:** gross income up to 200% FPL; same amounts and rules as Cecil (max $306 for 1, $808 for 3, $1,023 for 4). Apply at Kent DSS or MarylandBenefits.gov; ask for expedited 7-day SNAP.
- **WIC:** Upper Shore WIC, 151 Dixon Dr, Suite 2, Chestertown, 443-262-4423.
- **School meals and SUN Bucks:** as in Cecil.
- **Seniors:** daily hot lunch at the Amy Lynn Ferris Adult Activity Center, 200 Schauber Rd, Chestertown; Meals on Wheels through Upper Shore Aging, 410-778-6000.

Food pantry (call ahead)	Address	Phone	Hours
Kent County Community Pantry (no referral; up to twice a month)	105 N. Mill St (First UMC, Mill St entrance), Chestertown	410-778-0550	Tue/Thu 10–12
Chestertown SDA Church	305 N. Kent St, Chestertown	443-988-3886	Tuesdays 10–12 (not every week; call)
Millington-Crumpton Pantry	Asbury UMC, 392 Cypress St, Millington	443-480-0053	Mon 9–12 curbside; 2nd Mon 6–7 pm
Mt. Olive AME (drive-through)	24840 Lambs Meadow Rd, Worton	410-778-3328	3rd Fri 1–3 (call to confirm)
Hope Community Alliance (formerly Hope House)	6528 Rock Hall Rd, Rock Hall	443-960-1781	Thursdays 4–7 (1st & 3rd; call)
Rock Hall SDA	Sharp St & Judefind Ave, Rock Hall	—	Tue 3:30–5:30
River Market Blessing Box	120 E. Cross St, Galena	—	24/7

Cash Assistance

Same Maryland programs as Cecil, through Kent DSS (410-810-7600): TCA for families with children (max $773/month for 3); TDAP up to $348/month for adults without children disabled 3+ months; Emergency Assistance for families facing eviction or shutoff.

Disability Supports

SSDI and SSI: see *Federal Benefits*; call 1-800-772-1213 to find the office assigned to your ZIP code — there is no office in Kent County; the nearest are Elkton (300 Big Elk Mall, 1-866-331-2218), Annapolis and Cambridge. Local help: TDAP; Upper Shore Aging for in-home and waiver services, 410-778-6000.

Health Coverage and Care

- Maryland Medicaid (adults 138% FPL, pregnant 264%, children 322%): marylandhealthconnection.gov or 1-855-642-8572.

Low-cost care	Contact
Choptank Health – Chestertown Health Center (sliding fee)	126 Philosophers Terrace, Chestertown · 443-215-5353
Kent County Health Department (mental health, family planning, Medicaid rides)	125 S. Lynchburg St, Chestertown · 410-778-1350
UM Shore Medical Center at Chestertown (financial assistance)	100 Brown St · 410-778-3300
Mid Shore Behavioral Health	Easton · 410-770-4801
Crisis, 24/7 mobile team	888-407-8018 · 988

Housing and Homelessness

- **Shelter:** Kent DSS refers people to the Samaritan Group (410-810-7600): winter shelter January–March nightly 5:30 pm–8 am, motel placements April–December, plus eviction-prevention and utility help.
- **Rental assistance:** Maryland Rural Development Corp., 115 S. Lynchburg St, Chestertown, 667-254-8063 (also foreclosure help and credit counseling).
- **Housing Choice Vouchers:** Kent is served by Maryland DHCD (410-901-4080 or 1-800-756-0119). The Eastern Shore waitlist was open only in April 2026 and is now closed.
- **Domestic violence:** Mid-Shore Council on Family Violence, 24-hour hotline 1-800-927-4673.

2026 income limits, Kent (annual)	30% AMI	50% AMI
1 person	$23,550	$39,200
2 people	$26,900	$44,800
3 people	$30,250	$50,400
4 people	$33,600	$56,000

- **Eviction:** same Maryland rules as Cecil. Free lawyer: Maryland Legal Aid, 1-888-465-2468.

Utilities

Maryland energy assistance (MEAP, EUSP, arrearage help) to 200% FPL, year-round. In Kent, apply at Kent DSS, 350 High St, Chestertown, 410-810-7600, at MarylandBenefits.gov, or 1-800-332-6347.

Children and Families

- **Child Care Scholarship:** same statewide rules as Cecil.
- **Head Start:** Chestertown Center (Shore Up!), 115 S. Lynchburg St, Suite D (Shore Up! main office 410-749-1142).
- **Judy Center** at Henry Highland Garnett Elementary, 320 Calvert St, Chestertown (birth to kindergarten).
- **Child support:** 315 High St, Suite 208, Chestertown; 1-800-332-6347.

State Tax Credits

Maryland EITC, Child Tax Credit, Renters' and Homeowners' credits: same as Cecil. Ask the Kent County Treasurer about any county supplement to the Homeowners' credit.

Seniors and Veterans

Program	Contact
Upper Shore Aging (meals, in-home help, Maryland Access Point)	100 Schauber Rd, Chestertown · 410-778-6000 · Maryland Access Point 410-479-2535
MD veterans benefits, Upper Shore office	11 S. Harrison St, Easton
Cambridge VA Clinic	830 Chesapeake Dr, Cambridge · 410-228-6243
Perry Point VA Medical Center	410-642-2411
Maryland Veterans Trust Fund	410-260-3838

Legal Help and Transportation

- Maryland Legal Aid, Upper Eastern Shore office, 106 N. Washington St, Suite 101, Easton; intake 1-888-465-2468. Shore Legal Access (pro bono, serves Kent), Easton, 410-690-8128. Circuit Court, 103 N. Cross St, Chestertown, 410-778-7400.
- **MUST Bus** (866-330-6878): Route D4 Rock Hall–Chestertown–Centreville–Easton, weekdays about 5 am–3 pm, stopping at DSS and the hospital; will detour up to ¾ mile if you call 2 hours ahead (410-479-4974). Fares $3; $1.50 for seniors, disabled and Medicare; $1 with an Independence Card.
- **Medicaid rides:** Kent County Health Department, 410-778-7025 (book 48 hours ahead).

Kent County Contacts

Need	Phone
SNAP, cash, Medicaid, energy, shelter (DSS)	410-810-7600
Unemployment	667-207-6520
Job center	410-778-3525
Rental help (MRDC)	667-254-8063
Seniors (Upper Shore Aging)	410-778-6000
Clinic (Choptank Health)	443-215-5353
Crisis	888-407-8018

New Castle County, Delaware

Delaware runs its own programs with different rules and amounts from Maryland. Apply for SNAP, cash assistance, Medicaid and child care online at ASSIST or at a DHSS State Service Center (general line 302-255-9040). For anything else, dial 2-1-1 or text your ZIP to 898-211.

State Service Center	Address
Hudson (Newark)	501 Ogletown Rd, Newark 19711
Appoquinimink (Middletown)	122 Silver Lake Rd, Middletown 19709
DeLaWarr (New Castle)	500 Rogers Rd, New Castle 19720
Belvedere	310 Kiamensi Rd, Wilmington 19804
Claymont	3301 Green St, Claymont 19703
Northeast	1624 Jessup St, Wilmington 19802
Porter	509 W 8th St, Wilmington 19801
Canby Park	1920 Maryland Ave, Wilmington 19805

Unemployment Insurance (Delaware)

- $20–$450 a week for up to 26 weeks in a 52-week benefit year. The weekly amount is 1/46 of wages in your two highest-paid base-period quarters (base period = first four of the last five completed quarters).
- Apply online at ui.delawareworks.com or call the UI hotline 302-761-8446.
- File weekly (Sunday–Saturday weeks) by Weekly Pay Authorization or TeleBenefits; late claims are generally not backdated. Make at least 1 new work-search contact or activity every week and log it. Earnings up to $10 or 50% of your weekly benefit (whichever is more) are not deducted.
- **Denials:** quitting without good cause, discharge for just cause, refusing suitable work, or not being able and available.
- **Appeal within 10 calendar days** — shorter than Maryland — in writing to the Appeals Unit, PO Box 9950, Wilmington DE 19809. Keep filing weekly.

Jobs and Training

Office	Address	Employment & Training	Vocational Rehabilitation (disability)
Newark	University Office Plaza, 252 Chapman Rd, 2nd floor, Newark 19702	302-368-6622	302-368-6980
Wilmington (Fox Valley)	4425 N Market St, Wilmington 19802	302-761-8085	302-761-8275

These Delaware JobLink offices offer job search help and federally funded (WIOA) training for unemployed and low-income adults. Also: Goodwill Opportunity Hub, 300 E. Lea Blvd, Wilmington, 302-761-4640.

Food

- **SNAP (Oct 2026–Sep 2027):** gross income up to 200% FPL ($2,660 for 1, $4,554 for 3, $5,500 for 4); 165% for separate elderly/disabled households. People on TANF, GA or SSI skip the income test. Maximum benefits are the same national amounts ($306 for 1, $808 for 3, $1,023 for 4). Apply on ASSIST or at a State Service Center; decision within 30 days. Ask about expedited benefits if you have almost no cash.
- **Work rule:** adults 18–64 without a child under 14 need 80 hours a month of work or SNAP Employment & Training after 3 months (see *Federal Benefits*).
- **WIC:** all New Castle County clinics 302-283-7540 (Hudson State Service Center Newark, Claymont, Northeast, and West End Neighborhood House at 710 N Lincoln St, Wilmington).
- **Food Bank of Delaware,** 222 Lake Dr, Newark, 302-292-1305.

Food pantry or meal site (call ahead)	Address	Phone	Hours
Newark Area Welfare Committee	69 E Main St (Newark UMC), Newark	302-565-6560	Tue 3–4, Wed 1–2, Thu 2–3
Dream Center (Boxes of Hope)	310 Ruthar Dr, Units 9–11, Newark	302-286-7406	Last Fri of the month 10–1
Red Lion UMC Food Closet	1545 Church Rd, Bear	302-834-1599	Wed mornings until 12
St. Patrick’s Center	107 E 14th St, Wilmington	302-652-6219	Weekdays (call for pantry hours)
Salvation Army	400 N Orange St, Wilmington	302-472-0720	Mon–Fri 9–12
Our Daily Bread (hot meals, not groceries)	214 N Broad St, Middletown	302-285-9540	Mon–Fri 5–6 pm; Tue/Thu 12–1

Cash Assistance

Program	Who	Amount and rules
TANF	Families with children	FY2027 monthly payment: 1 = $241, 2 = $324, 3 = $405, 4 = $488. Gross income under $1,846 (1) to $3,817 (4); resources under $10,000; generally 36-month limit; 30 hours a week of work activities; child support cooperation
General Assistance (state)	Adults 18–54 unable to work (doctor's form), caring for a sick household member, 55+ with no income, or students over 18	1 = $79, 2 = $107, 3 = $144, 4 = $169 a month
Emergency Assistance Services	Households facing eviction, shutoff, homelessness or no food	Through State Service Centers, 1-866-843-7212; motel vouchers up to $1,200 per person per year

Disability Supports

SSDI and SSI: see *Federal Benefits*. Social Security office: 920 W Basin Rd, Suite 200, New Castle (866-667-7221; Mon–Fri 9–4). Delaware Vocational Rehabilitation: Newark 302-368-6980, Wilmington 302-761-8275. Aging and disability services: ADRC, 1-800-223-9074.

Health Coverage and Care

- **Delaware Medicaid:** adults 19–64 to 138% FPL (about $1,835/month for 1) with no asset test. Delaware Healthy Children Program covers children to 212% FPL ($4,827/month for 3). Apply on ASSIST or call 302-255-9040.
- Work requirement for expansion adults starts January 1, 2027, with 6-month renewals (see *Federal Benefits*).
- **Private plans:** Delaware uses HealthCare.gov (1-800-318-2596); open enrollment for 2027 starts November 1, 2026.

Low-cost care	Contact
Westside Family Healthcare (sliding fee)	27 Marrows Rd, Newark; 404 Foxhunt Dr, Bear; two Wilmington sites · 302-224-6800
Henrietta Johnson Medical Center	601 New Castle Ave, Wilmington; 2722 Philadelphia Pike, Claymont · 302-655-6187
ChristianaCare financial assistance (free care below 400% FPL)	302-623-7440
New Castle County Mobile Crisis (24/7)	302-577-2484 or 800-652-2929
Recovery Response Center (24/7 walk-in)	659 E Chestnut Hill Rd, Newark · 302-318-6070
Delaware Hope Line	1-833-946-7333 · 988

Housing and Homelessness

- **Homeless:** call or text Centralized Intake, 1-833-346-3233 (1-833-FIND-BED), Mon–Fri 8–5; call daily if not placed. Freezing nights (Code Purple): 1-800-560-3372 or 211.
- **Shelters and day centers:** Sunday Breakfast Mission, 110 N Poplar St, Wilmington, 877-306-4663; Friendship House, Newark center 300 E Main St, 302-544-0165, and Wilmington center 720 N Orange St, 302-652-8033.

Housing authority	Address	Phone
New Castle County Housing Authority	77 Reads Way, New Castle	302-395-5600
Newark Housing Authority	313 E Main St, Newark	302-366-0826
Wilmington Housing Authority	400 N Walnut St, Wilmington	302-429-6701
Delaware State Housing Authority	18 The Green, Dover	888-363-8808

All five Delaware housing authorities share one waiting list at Delaware.AffordableHousing.com (open as of May 2026; help line 855-301-5920; New Castle County list 302-395-5675). Vouchers generally require income under 50% of area median (about $42,950 for 1 and $61,350 for 4 in the Wilmington area).

- **Eviction (Delaware law):** the landlord must give at least 7 days' written notice for unpaid rent before filing in Justice of the Peace Court. Tenants at or below 200% FPL have a right to a free lawyer in eviction cases (phasing in through 2028; families with children and pregnant women first) — call Delaware Volunteer Legal Services, 302-478-8680, or CLASI. Only a constable can carry out an eviction after a court judgment.

Utilities

- **LIHEAP** (income up to 60% of state median income): winter heating help October 1–March 31; crisis help year-round with a shutoff notice or under 10% of fuel; summer cooling help. New Castle County applications: Catholic Charities, 19 Lambson Ln, Rosehill Community Center Suite A109, New Castle, 302-654-9295.
- **Delmarva Power Customer Relief Fund (2026):** for LIHEAP-eligible customers or households up to 350% FPL with a balance of $250+; requires an Energize Delaware energy checkup. 302-883-3048 or energizedelaware.org.
- **Weatherization:** DNREC, 302-735-3480.

Children and Families

- **Purchase of Care** (child care subsidy): income up to 225% FPL at application ($5,123/month for 3), up to 325% at renewal; children under 13; income-based copay. Apply on ASSIST; referrals 1-800-220-3092.
- **Kinship Care Program** (relatives raising a child): help with urgent needs in the first 180 days, 302-255-9040.
- **Child support:** Delaware Division of Child Support Services, 302-577-7171.

State and Local Tax Credits

- **Delaware EITC:** choose a refundable credit of 4.5% of the federal EITC or a non-refundable 20%.
- **Senior School Property Tax Credit:** homeowners 65+ (by June 30) on their main home; apply by April 30. New Castle County Assessment, 302-395-5520.

Seniors and Veterans

Program	Contact
Aging and Disability Resource Center (DSAAPD)	1-800-223-9074
Delaware Medicare Assistance Bureau (free Medicare counseling)	1-800-336-9500
Newark Senior Center	200 White Chapel Dr, Newark · 302-737-2336
MOT Senior Center	300 S Scott St, Middletown · 302-378-4758
Delaware Office of Veterans Services	302-739-2792
Wilmington VA Medical Center	1601 Kirkwood Hwy, Wilmington · 302-994-2511

Legal Help and Transportation

- Community Legal Aid Society (CLASI), 100 W 10th St, Suite 801, Wilmington, 302-575-0660 or 800-292-7980; Legal Services Corporation of Delaware, 302-575-0408; Delaware Volunteer Legal Services, 302-478-8680.
- **DART buses:** fares from $2, one-zone day pass $4, reduced fares for seniors, people with disabilities and Medicare cardholders; 1-800-652-3278. Cecil Transit Routes 1 and 4 connect Elkton to Glasgow and Newark.
- **Medicaid rides:** Modivcare, 1-866-412-3778 (book 3 days ahead).

New Castle County Contacts

Need	Phone
SNAP, cash, Medicaid (DHSS)	302-255-9040
Unemployment	302-761-8446
Job center (Newark)	302-368-6622
Shelter (Centralized Intake)	1-833-346-3233
Energy (Catholic Charities)	302-654-9295
Eviction lawyer (DVLS)	302-478-8680
Seniors (ADRC)	1-800-223-9074
Crisis	800-652-2929

Lancaster County, Pennsylvania

Start at the **Lancaster County Assistance Office**, 832 Manor St, Lancaster, PA 17603, 717-299-7411 (Mon/Tue/Wed/Fri 8–5, Thu 11–5), or apply online at COMPASS for SNAP, cash assistance, Medical Assistance, LIHEAP and child care. State helpline 1-800-692-7462. This section gives the full Pennsylvania rules that also apply in Chester County.

Unemployment Compensation (Pennsylvania)

- Weekly benefit is set by your highest-paid base-year quarter and works out to roughly half your full-time weekly pay (a $7,500 high quarter gives $295). The weekly benefit ranges from $68 to $605, plus up to $8 for dependents ($5 for a spouse or first child, $3 for a second). Benefits are not taxed by Pennsylvania.
- **To qualify:** at least 18 credit weeks, and at least 37% of base-year wages earned outside the high quarter.
- **Length:** 18 to 26 weeks, depending on your credit weeks. The first week is an unpaid waiting week.
- **Part-time work:** earnings up to 30% of your weekly benefit don’t reduce it; earnings above that are subtracted.
- Severance above 40% of the state average annual wage delays benefits; pensions paid by the employer reduce benefits. Social Security does not.

How to apply

1. Apply at uc.pa.gov or call the UC Service Center, 1-888-313-7284.
2. Register on PA CareerLink within 30 days.
3. File your weekly or biweekly claim on time.
4. Search for work every week starting the third week you file — apply for 2 jobs and do 1 work-search activity — and keep a written record.
5. Appeal by the deadline printed on your determination notice (21 calendar days).

You can be denied for quitting without a “necessitous and compelling” reason (you must prove it) or being fired for willful misconduct (the employer must prove it).

Jobs and Training

- **PA CareerLink Lancaster County,** 1046 Manheim Pike, Lancaster, 717-509-5613 (Mon–Fri 8:30–5): job search help and WIOA-funded training. Lancaster County Workforce Development Board, same building, 717-735-0333.
- **Office of Vocational Rehabilitation** (disability job services), York district office covering Lancaster: 2550 Kingston Rd, Suite 101, York, 717-771-4407 or 800-762-6306.
- **Thaddeus Stevens College of Technology,** 750 E King St, 717-299-7701: Stevens Grant covers tuition, meals and housing for eligible students. **HACC Lancaster:** apply for aid through the FAFSA; workforce training 717-221-1332.

- **Libraries:** Lancaster Public Library, 151 N Queen St, 717-394-2651; Quarryville Library, 357 Buck Rd, 717-786-1336 (job resources).

Food

- **SNAP (Oct 2026–Sep 2027):** gross income up to 200% FPL for all households ($2,660 for 1, $4,554 for 3, $5,500 for 4); same national maximum benefits ($306 for 1, $808 for 3, $1,023 for 4). Apply on COMPASS or at the County Assistance Office; ask for expedited benefits if you have almost no cash. The federal work rule has applied since November 1, 2025, and Pennsylvania's waivers ended.
- **WIC** (run by Community Action Partnership; one number for all sites 717-509-3686): 601 S Queen St, Lancaster; 406 Chestnut St, Columbia; 108 N Reading Rd, Ephrata; mobile clinic in Quarryville at Solanco Neighborhood Ministries on Tuesdays.
- **School meals and SUN Bucks** summer food benefits for children: apply through your school district.

Food pantry (call ahead)	Address	Phone	Hours
Solanco Food Bank (by appointment)	14 S Church St, Quarryville	717-786-4308	Mon–Thu 9–12 & 1–4, Fri 9–12
Lancaster County Food Hub (walk-in)	812 N Queen St, Lancaster	717-291-6403	Mon/Tue/Thu/Fri 9:30–11:45
Community Hive (by appointment)	227 N State St, Ephrata	717-733-0345	Office Mon–Fri 9–4
Columbia Food Bank (Columbia area only)	340 Locust St (rear), Columbia	717-449-5101	Mon–Wed 9:30–11:30; new clients by 11
Community Cupboard of Elizabethtown (appointment; Elizabethtown, Bainbridge, Rheems)	61 E Washington St, Elizabethtown	717-361-8149	Wed & Sat 10–1:30

Cash Assistance

- **TANF** (families with children): up to $421 a month for a family of 3 (statewide range $365–$421 by county; confirm your county's amount with the County Assistance Office); $1,000 asset limit; 60-month lifetime limit; you sign an Agreement of Mutual Responsibility and take part in work activities. The first $200 earned per worker plus half the rest is not counted.
- Pennsylvania ended General Assistance cash for adults without children in 2019. SSI recipients get a small state supplement ($22.10 a month for an individual).

Disability Supports

SSDI and SSI: see *Federal Benefits*; call 1-800-772-1213 for an appointment at the Lancaster Social Security office, 1808 Colonial Village Ln, Suite 101, Lancaster (888-384-9919). Local

help: OVR (717-771-4407); Lancaster County Office of Aging for in-home and waiver services (717-299-7979).

Health Coverage and Care

- **Medical Assistance (Medicaid):** adults to 138% FPL ($22,025/year for 1, $45,540 for 4). CHIP covers children to 314% FPL, free below 208%. Apply on COMPASS, by phone 1-866-550-4355, or at the County Assistance Office.
- **Changes:** work requirement and 6-month renewals for expansion adults start January 2027; retroactive coverage drops to 1 month (see *Federal Benefits*).
- **Private plans:** Pennie (Pennsylvania's marketplace), 1-844-844-8040. Open enrollment for 2027 runs November 1, 2026–January 15, 2027; enroll by December 15 for January 1 coverage.

Low-cost care	Contact
Union Community Care (sliding fee; includes the former SouthEast Lancaster Health Services)	304 N Water St, 625 S Duke St, 234 W Orange St, Lancaster; New Holland · 717-299-6371
Crisis Intervention (24/7)	717-394-2631 · 988

Housing and Homelessness

- **Homeless:** coordinated entry through 2-1-1 or 1-855-567-5341. Water Street Mission, 210 S Prince St, Lancaster, 717-393-7709 (24/7; requires 90 days of county residency). Milagro House (education-focused housing for women and children), 717-509-1401. Domestic Violence Services hotline, 717-299-1249.
- **Vouchers:** Lancaster County Housing & Redevelopment Authority, 28 Penn Square, Suite 200, 717-394-0793; Lancaster City Housing Authority, 325 Church St, 717-397-2835 (online applications). Both voucher waitlists are closed; ask about public housing and project-based units.

FY2026 income limits, Lancaster (annual)	30% AMI	50% AMI
1 person	$22,950	$38,250
2 people	$26,200	$43,700
3 people	$29,500	$49,150
4 people	$33,000	$54,600

Eviction (Pennsylvania law)

1. The landlord must give a written Notice to Quit — 10 days for unpaid rent unless the lease says otherwise; it must be handed to you or posted, not just mailed.
2. The landlord files at the Magisterial District Court; the hearing is usually 7–15 days later. Go to it.
3. You have 10 days to appeal a possession judgment (bond required).

4. An Order for Possession can be requested after 10 days, and the constable gives 10 more days, so a lockout is at least about 20 days after the hearing.
5. **Pay and stay:** paying the full judgment plus costs before the lockout stops the eviction (in cash to the constable on eviction day).
6. **Free legal help:** MidPenn Legal Services, 1-800-326-9177.

Utilities

- **LIHEAP 2026–27 opens November 2, 2026.** Income up to 150% FPL ($23,940/year for 1, $40,980 for 3, $49,500 for 4). Cash grants of $200–$1,000 are paid to your utility or fuel company; crisis grants help with a shutoff notice, broken heater or under 15 days of fuel. Apply on COMPASS or at 832 Manor St; LIHEAP hotline 1-866-857-7095.
- **Winter shutoff protection:** December 1–March 31 for electric and gas customers at or below 250% FPL.
- Ask PPL (OnTrack) or UGI about their customer assistance programs; Community Action Partnership also helps with PPL and UGI bills.

Children and Families

- **Child Care Works subsidy:** income up to 200% FPL at entry ($54,640/year for 3); parents must work 20 hours a week (or 10 hours work plus 10 training); income-based copay. Apply through Early Learning Resource Center Region 10, 601 S Queen St (CAP), 717-393-4004, or COMPASS.
- **Head Start and Thrive to Five:** Community Action Partnership, 601 S Queen St, 717-299-7301 (also WIC, senior centers, a food pantry, utility help, and a Promoting Responsible Fatherhood program).
- **Kinship families:** PA KinConnector helpline 1-866-546-2111.
- **Child support:** Lancaster County Domestic Relations, 150 N Queen St, Suite 220, 717-299-8141.

State Tax Credits

Credit	Amount	Who
Working Pennsylvanians Tax Credit (new)	10% of federal EITC, up to $805	Anyone who gets the federal EITC; claim on the PA-40
Tax Forgiveness (Schedule SP)	Up to 100% of PA income tax	Single income up to $6,500 + $9,500 per dependent; must file the schedule
Property Tax/Rent Rebate	$380–$1,000	65+, widows/widowers 50+, or disabled 18+ with income up to $48,110 (half of Social Security excluded); 2025 claims due December 31, 2026

Seniors and Veterans

Program	Contact
Lancaster County Office of Aging	150 N Queen St, Suite 415 · 717-299-7979 or 1-800-801-3070
PA MEDI (free Medicare counseling)	1-800-783-7067
PACE / PACENET prescription help (65+; income up to $14,500 / $33,500 single)	1-800-225-7223
Lancaster County Veterans Affairs (daily van to Lebanon VA)	150 N Queen St, Suite 103 · 717-299-7920
Lancaster County VA Clinic	212 Willow Valley Lakes Dr, Suite 208, Willow Street
Lebanon VA Medical Center	1700 S Lincoln Ave, Lebanon

Legal Help and Transportation

- MidPenn Legal Services, 38 N Christian St, Suite 200, Lancaster, 717-299-0971; apply at 1-800-326-9177. Lancaster Bar lawyer referral, 717-393-0737.
- **Red Rose Transit** (717-397-4246): adult fare $1.80, half fare $0.90 for people with disabilities; seniors 65+ ride free with the state program. Red Rose Access shared ride and Medical Assistance trips: 717-291-1243.

Lancaster County Contacts

Need	Phone
SNAP, cash, Medical Assistance, LIHEAP (CAO)	717-299-7411
Unemployment	1-888-313-7284
CareerLink	717-509-5613
Homeless coordinated entry	2-1-1 or 1-855-567-5341
Community Action Partnership	717-299-7301
Child care subsidy (ELRC)	717-393-4004
Office of Aging	717-299-7979
Crisis	717-394-2631

Chester County, Pennsylvania

Start at the **Chester County Assistance Office**, 100 James Buchanan Dr, Thorndale, PA 19372, 610-466-1000 (toll-free 888-814-4698; Mon–Fri 8–5), or apply online at COMPASS. Chester uses the same Pennsylvania programs and rules as Lancaster County; the key numbers are repeated here, and the Lancaster section has the full detail.

Unemployment Compensation (Pennsylvania)

- Weekly benefit is roughly half your full-time weekly pay ($68–$605, plus up to $8 for dependents; first week unpaid) for 18–26 weeks.
- Apply at uc.pa.gov or 1-888-313-7284; register on PA CareerLink within 30 days; apply for 2 jobs plus 1 work-search activity each week from the third week; appeal within 21 days.

Jobs and Training

- **PA CareerLink Chester County,** 479 Thomas Jones Way, Suite 500, Exton, 610-280-1010: job search help and WIOA-funded training. Workforce Development Board, 601 Westtown Rd, Suite 365, West Chester, 610-344-6900.
- **Office of Vocational Rehabilitation,** Norristown district (covers Chester), 1875 New Hope St, Norristown, 484-250-4340 or 800-221-1042.
- **Delaware County Community College** Chester County sites: Pennocks Bridge Center, 280 Pennocks Bridge Rd, West Grove, 484-237-6400; Downingtown, 484-237-6200.
- **Chester County OIC,** 22 N. 5th Ave, Coatesville, 610-692-2344: job training, GED and ESL, driver’s education.
- **Chester County Library Business & Career Center,** 450 Exton Square Pkwy, Exton: résumé workshops and CareerLink drop-in hours Tuesdays 12–3.

Food

- **SNAP:** gross income up to 200% FPL; same rules and amounts as Lancaster (max $306 for 1, $808 for 3, $1,023 for 4). Apply on COMPASS or at the Thorndale office; the Chester County Food Bank can also help you apply.
- **WIC** (Chester County Health Department): West Chester, 601 Westtown Rd, Suite 190, 610-344-6240; Coatesville, 1001 E Lincoln Hwy, 610-455-1340; Toughkenamon, 1140 Newark Rd, Suite 400-A, 610-455-1345; Oxford satellite at Oxford Presbyterian, 6 Pine St, 610-455-1345.
- **Chester County Food Bank,** 650 Pennsylvania Dr, Exton, 610-873-6000 (online Food Finder).
- **Senior meals:** weekday lunch at senior centers (reserve 48 hours ahead); Meals on Wheels of Chester County, 610-430-8500.

Food pantry (call ahead)	Address	Phone	Hours
Oxford Area Neighborhood Services	35 N 3rd St, Oxford	610-932-8557	Mon/Tue/Thu 8:30–4:30 by appointment; walk-in Mon 3–6
Kennett Area Community Service	136 W Cedar St, Kennett Square (may move to W Cypress St)	610-925-3556	Tue 12–6, Wed 12–7, Thu 12–6
Bridge Pantry (Avon Grove Nazarene)	240 State Rd, West Grove	610-869-9500	Tue 6–8 pm
West Grove UMC	300 N Guernsey Rd, West Grove	610-869-9334	Wed 5–6 pm, Thu 1–2
Coatesville Salvation Army	669 E Lincoln Hwy, Coatesville	610-384-2954	Mon 10–12, Tue 12–2:30, Wed 11:30–1:30, Thu 10:30–12
Coatesville Community Food Co-op	800 S 1st Ave, Coatesville	610-384-1344	3rd Sat 9:30–1; 4th Thu 6–7:30 pm
Lord’s Pantry of Downingtown	141 E Lancaster Ave, Downingtown	610-873-1149	Mon/Tue 10–12:30; Thu 10–12:30 & 5–7:30

Cash Assistance

TANF for families with children: up to $421 a month for a family of 3 (confirm your county’s amount); $1,000 asset limit; 60-month limit; work activities required. No state General Assistance cash for adults without children. Apply at the Thorndale office or COMPASS. The county’s Community Action Agency (Department of Community Development, 610-344-6000) funds case management, job readiness and housing help.

Disability Supports

SSDI and SSI: see *Federal Benefits*. Social Security office: 1101 West Chester Pike, West Chester (888-306-3216; Mon–Fri 9–4). Local help: OVR Norristown (484-250-4340); Department of Aging Services for in-home help (610-344-6350).

Health Coverage and Care

- Medical Assistance (adults 138% FPL), CHIP (children to 314%, free below 208%), and Pennie private plans (open enrollment November 1, 2026–January 15, 2027): same as Lancaster. Apply on COMPASS or 1-866-550-4355.

Low-cost care	Contact
La Comunidad Hispana (sliding fee)	731 W Cypress St, Kennett Square; 303 N 3rd St, Oxford · 610-444-7550
ChesPenn Center for Family Health (sliding fee)	744 E Lincoln Hwy, Suite 110, Coatesville · 610-380-4660
Community Volunteers in Medicine (free for uninsured)	300 B Lawrence Dr, West Chester; West Grove satellite Fridays · 610-836-5990
Chester County Health Department	601 Westtown Rd, Suite 295, West Chester · 610-344-6225
Penn Medicine / Chester County Hospital financial assistance (free below 300% FPL)	1-877-433-5299
Crisis (24/7, mobile teams)	610-280-3270 · 988

The former Jennersville Hospital has been closed since 2021; ChristianaCare primary care operates in Jennersville, West Grove and Kennett.

Housing and Homelessness

- **Homeless:** coordinated entry through 2-1-1 (or text your ZIP to 898-211; staffed Mon–Fri 8 am–8 pm).

Shelter or program	Who	Phone
Safe Harbor, 20 N Matlack St, West Chester	Adults	610-692-6550
Friends Association, West Chester	Families (enter through 211)	610-431-3598
The Oaks Ministry, Oxford	Single women	484-368-7268
Bridge of Hope	Single-parent families	610-280-0280
Home of the Sparrow	Eviction prevention	610-647-4940
Domestic Violence Center of Chester County	24/7 hotline	888-711-6270

- **Vouchers:** Housing Authority of the County of Chester, 30 W Barnard St, West Chester, 610-436-9200. The Housing Choice Voucher waitlist has been closed for years; ask about project-based units.

FY2026 income limits, Chester (annual)	30% AMI	50% AMI
1 person	$25,800	$42,950
2 people	$29,450	$49,100
3 people	$33,150	$55,250
4 people	$36,800	$61,350

- **Eviction:** same Pennsylvania rules as Lancaster (10-day Notice to Quit, Magisterial District Court, 10 days to appeal, pay the full judgment to stay). Free help: Legal Aid of Southeastern PA, 610-436-4510.

Utilities

LIHEAP opens November 2, 2026 (income up to 150% FPL; grants $200–$1,000; crisis grants for shutoffs and fuel emergencies). Chester County LIHEAP office: 610-466-1042, or apply on COMPASS. Winter shutoff protection December 1–March 31 for households at or below 250% FPL. Ask PECO about its Customer Assistance Program.

Children and Families

- **Child Care Works** (income to 200% FPL at entry): Early Learning Resource Center Region 19, 455 Boot Rd, Downingtown, 484-593-5050.
- **Head Start** (Chester County Intermediate Unit; 12 centers including Oxford, Kennett, Coatesville, West Chester and Jennersville): 610-383-6800. Income at or below 100% FPL; Pre-K Counts up to 300%.
- **Child support:** Domestic Relations, Justice Center, 201 W Market St, Suite 3400, West Chester, 610-344-6215.

State Tax Credits

Working Pennsylvanians Tax Credit (10% of federal EITC, up to $805), Tax Forgiveness (Schedule SP) and the Property Tax/Rent Rebate ($380–$1,000 for 65+, widows 50+ or disabled; 2025 claims due December 31, 2026): same as Lancaster.

Seniors and Veterans

Program	Contact
Chester County Department of Aging Services	601 Westtown Rd, Suite 130, West Chester · 610-344-6350
PA MEDI (Medicare counseling)	610-344-5004
Oxford Senior Center	12 E Locust St, Oxford · 610-932-5244
The Gathering Place at Kennett	427 S Walnut St, Kennett Square · 610-444-4819
Chester County Veteran Service Office	601 Westtown Rd, Suite 170, West Chester · 610-344-5210
Coatesville VA Medical Center	1400 Black Horse Hill Rd, Coatesville · 610-384-7711

Legal Help and Transportation

- Legal Aid of Southeastern PA, 222 N Walnut St, 2nd floor, West Chester, 610-436-4510; helpline 877-429-5994. Chester County Bar lawyer referral, 610-429-1500.

- **Chesco Connect** shared ride (seniors 65+, Medical Assistance trips, people with disabilities, general public at full fare): 610-344-5545, Mon–Fri 7–5:30.
- **SCCOOT bus** (Oxford–Kennett–West Chester, weekdays): $3.25 cash, free for seniors 65+ with PA ID; 610-993-0911. SEPTA Route 135 links Coatesville and West Chester.

Chester County Contacts

Need	Phone
SNAP, cash, Medical Assistance (CAO)	610-466-1000
LIHEAP	610-466-1042
Unemployment	1-888-313-7284
CareerLink	610-280-1010
Homeless coordinated entry	2-1-1
Child care subsidy (ELRC 19)	484-593-5050
Aging Services	610-344-6350
Crisis	610-280-3270

Counseling, Mental Health and Addiction

Everything in this section is available whether or not you have insurance, money, or an address.

Anywhere, 24 Hours a Day

- **988** — Suicide & Crisis Lifeline. Call or text. Free and confidential.
- **Crisis Text Line** — text HOME to 741741.
- **SAMHSA National Helpline** — 1-800-662-4357 — free, confidential, 24/7 treatment referral.
- **Veterans Crisis Line** — dial 988, then press 1, or text 838255.

Cecil County, MD

- Eastern Shore Crisis Response Hotline: 888-407-8018 — 24/7.
- Cecil Addiction Treatment Coordination Hotline (CATCH): 443-245-3257.
- Maryland Crisis Hotline: 1-800-422-0009 — 24/7 statewide.
- Emergency psychiatric services: ChristianaCare Union Hospital, 106 Bow St., Elkton · 410-398-4000.
- West Cecil Health Center — sliding-fee medical, dental, and behavioral health · 410-378-9696.
- Upper Bay Counseling — 200 Booth St., Elkton · 410-996-3450.

Harford County, MD

- Harford Crisis Response: 1-800-639-8783 — 24/7 (1-800-NEXT-STEP).
- Mobile Crisis Team: 410-638-5248 — they will come to you; also books urgent-care appointments within 48 hours.
- **Klein Family Harford Crisis Center** — 802 Baltimore Pike, Bel Air, MD 21014 — walk-in 9 a.m.–9 p.m., 7 days a week · 443-643-2422.
- Aberdeen Vet Center — 223 W. Bel Air Ave., Aberdeen · 410-272-6771 — trauma and PTSD treatment for veterans.

Kent County, MD

- Eastern Shore Crisis Response Hotline: 888-407-8018 — 24/7.
- For All Seasons, Inc. (rape crisis and behavioral health): 410-820-5600 (24/7); Spanish call or text 410-829-6143.
- Mid-Shore Council on Family Violence: 1-800-927-4673.

New Castle County, DE

- Delaware Crisis Intervention Services (adults 18+): 1-800-652-2929 — 24/7.
- New Castle County Mobile Crisis: 302-577-2484.
- **Recovery Response Center** — 659 E. Chestnut Hill Rd., Newark, DE 19713 · 302-318-6070 (24/7 walk-in).
- Delaware Hope Line (support and referrals): 1-833-946-7333.
- ContactLifeline crisis counselor: 1-800-262-9800.
- Youth in crisis (ages 2–17): 1-800-969-4357.

Lancaster County, PA

- **Lancaster County Crisis Intervention:** 717-394-2631 — 24/7. Staff can assess by phone, come to your location, or see you in person at 750 Eden Rd., Lancaster.
- Lancaster County Behavioral Health & Developmental Services — 150 N. Queen St., Suite 610 · 717-299-8021.

Chester County, PA

- Chester County Crisis Intervention: 610-280-3270 (24/7; ask for a Mobile Crisis Resolution Team). Valley Creek Crisis Walk-in Center, 7 a.m.–11 p.m., same number. Peer Warmline (not crisis): 866-846-2722.
- Chester County Dept. of Drug and Alcohol Services: 610-344-6620.
- Crime Victims' Center of Chester County (24/7): 610-692-7273.
- ChesPenn / Coatesville Center for Community Health — 610-380-4660 — health care for the homeless, primary care, counseling.

Help Through the Church

Latter-day Saint Family Services offers counseling for members and others in many areas; ask your bishop about a referral and possible help with costs. The Church's Addiction Recovery Program holds free, confidential support meetings open to anyone (addictionrecovery.churchofjesuschrist.org).

Suicide Prevention and Emotional Support

If you are thinking about ending your life, help is free, confidential, and available this minute.

> **Call or text 988.** The Suicide & Crisis Lifeline works anywhere in the United States, 24 hours a day. Chat at 988lifeline.org. Press 1 for the Veterans Crisis Line · Press 2 for Spanish. TTY: dial 711, then 988. Or text **HOME to 741741**.

What Actually Happens When You Call

A trained counselor answers. They listen. They do not send police unless you are in immediate physical danger and cannot stay safe — the vast majority of calls end with a conversation and a plan, nothing more. You can stay anonymous. You can call about someone else. You can call when you are not in crisis but are struggling and need to talk to a person. There is no wrong reason to call.

Local Crisis Lines — 24 Hours

County	Number
Cecil County, MD	888-407-8018 — Eastern Shore Crisis Response
Harford County, MD	1-800-639-8783 — Harford Crisis Response
Harford Mobile Crisis Team	410-638-5248 — they come to you
Kent County, MD	888-407-8018 — Eastern Shore Crisis Response
Maryland statewide	1-800-422-0009
New Castle County, DE	1-800-652-2929 — Crisis Intervention Services
Delaware — talk to a counselor	1-800-262-9800 — ContactLifeline
Delaware youth (2–17)	1-800-969-4357
Lancaster County, PA	717-394-2631 — Crisis Intervention
Chester County, PA	610-280-3270 — Crisis Intervention

Places You Can Walk Into

- **Klein Family Harford Crisis Center** — 802 Baltimore Pike, Bel Air, MD — walk-in 9 a.m.–9 p.m., 7 days a week.
- **Recovery Response Center** — 659 E. Chestnut Hill Rd., Newark, DE — 302-318-6070.
- **Lancaster County Crisis Intervention** — 750 Eden Rd., Lancaster, PA.
- **Valley Creek Crisis Walk-in Center** (Chester County) — 7 a.m.–11 p.m.; call 610-280-3270 for directions.

- **Any hospital emergency department.** They cannot turn you away, and they can connect you to crisis services.

If You Are Supporting Someone Else

- **Ask directly.** Asking someone whether they are thinking about suicide does not plant the idea. It is one of the most protective things you can do.
- **Listen without arguing.** You do not have to fix it or talk them out of it. Staying present matters more than saying the right thing.
- **Put distance between them and the means of harm.** If they have access to anything they could use to harm themselves, ask if a trusted person can hold onto it for a while.
- **Do not leave them alone if the danger feels immediate.** Call 988 together, or 911 if there is immediate physical danger.
- You can call 988 for guidance about someone else. You do not need their permission.

Specialized Lines

- Veterans Crisis Line — 988, press 1 · text 838255 · veteranscrisisline.net
- Trevor Project (LGBTQ+ young people, 24/7) — 1-866-488-7386 · text START to 678-678
- SAMHSA National Helpline (mental health and substance use treatment referral) — 1-800-662-4357
- National Domestic Violence Hotline — 1-800-799-7233

Why This Section Is in This Guide

Losing a job, income or housing is one of the most destabilizing things that can happen to a person, and the despair that comes with it is a normal response to an abnormal situation — not a character flaw and not permanent. Many people reading this have already survived more than most people ever will. If today is the hardest day, please make one call before you make any other decision. 988. That is all it takes.

Jobs, Training and Education

All of these are free. They have computers, printers, phones, and internet you can use for job searching, plus staff who will sit with you on a résumé. Several will pay for training or certifications. For much more, see the stake's *Finding Work* guide.

County	Center	Phone
Cecil, MD	Susquehanna Workforce Center – Elkton, 1275 W. Pulaski Hwy. (Mon–Fri 8–4:30)	410-996-0550
Harford, MD	Susquehanna Workforce Center – Swan Creek, 2129 Pulaski Hwy., Suite 101, Havre de Grace	410-272-5400
Kent, MD	Kent County American Job Center, 115A S. Lynchburg St., Chestertown	410-778-3525
New Castle, DE	Delaware JobLink – Newark, 252 Chapman Rd. / Wilmington, 4425 N. Market St.	302-368-6622 / 302-761-8085
Lancaster, PA	PA CareerLink Lancaster County, 1046 Manheim Pike	717-509-5613
Chester, PA	PA CareerLink Chester County, 479 Thomas Jones Way, Suite 500, Exton	610-280-1010

What they offer: career consultation, résumé help, interview practice, job placement, short-term training aligned to local employer demand, GED and adult basic education, youth services, and referrals.

Other Free Job Programs

- **Ministry of Caring — Francis X. Norton Center,** Wilmington · 302-652-5523. Job training and placement for people in its shelter continuum.
- **Sunday Breakfast Mission — New Life Program:** life skills, job preparedness, and job training alongside housing.
- **Tenfold (Lancaster)** — 717-397-5182 — financial coaching and housing counseling alongside shelter.
- **Goodwill Opportunity Hub,** 300 E. Lea Blvd., Wilmington · 302-761-4640 — career navigators, computers, reentry support.
- **Chester County OIC,** Coatesville · 610-692-2344 — training, GED, work clothing.

Coming Changes and Notes

Figures were checked against official sources in October 2026. Programs change often, so call before visiting.

Dates to Watch

Date	What changes
Mid-October 2026	The 2027 Social Security cost-of-living increase is announced
November 1, 2026	Open enrollment for 2027 health plans starts in all three states
November 2, 2026	Pennsylvania LIHEAP opens
December 31, 2026	Deadline for 2025 Pennsylvania Property Tax/Rent Rebate claims
January 1, 2027	Medicaid work reporting and 6-month renewals start in all three states; Maryland may start an income-based child care copay

Could Not Be Confirmed from an Official Source

Call before relying on these:

- Social Security office addresses outside Maryland come from third-party listings; check ssa.gov/locator with your ZIP code.
- Exact Pennsylvania TANF amounts for Lancaster and Chester counties (statewide range for a family of 3 is $365–$421).
- Whether Maryland or Delaware has an unpaid waiting week for unemployment (none is stated on official pages).
- Wilmington and Newark housing authority status beyond the shared statewide list.
- Several pantries' sources disagree on days (Chestertown SDA, Mt. Olive AME, Hope Community Alliance, St. Patrick's Center).

Other Stake Guides

- *Finding Work: A Job Search Resource Guide* — resumes, cover letters, job centers, interviews.
- *Emergency Housing: Help Is Available* — shelter, crisis lines, day centers.
- *Free Legal Help: Family, Divorce, Custody and Abuse* — legal aid for families, men, women and survivors.

Important Disclaimers and Sources

Please Read Before You Rely on This Guide

- **General information only.** This guide is for general reference. It is not legal, medical, financial, tax or immigration advice, and it does not create a lawyer–client, counselor–client or any other professional relationship.
- **No guarantee of eligibility or services.** Listing a program does not mean you qualify or that space, money or appointments are available. Each agency makes its own decisions.
- **Information changes.** Details were checked in October 2026 against official and organization websites. Phone numbers, addresses, hours, income limits and dollar amounts change often, sometimes without notice. Call to confirm before you travel, apply or make a decision.
- **Not an endorsement.** Organizations are listed only because they serve people in our area. The Wilmington Delaware Stake and The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints do not endorse, sponsor or take responsibility for any outside organization, its staff or its services.
- **Not an official Church publication.** This guide was compiled by local volunteers. The quotation on the cover is included for encouragement; you do not need to share any faith to use any resource in this guide.
- **Emergencies.** If anyone is in immediate danger, call **911**. For a mental-health or suicide crisis, call or text **988**. For anything else, dial **211**.
- **Eligibility and amounts.** Income limits, benefit amounts and deadlines are 2026 figures summarized from agency sources. The agency's written decision controls. Report changes in income or household as required to avoid overpayments.
- **Taxes.** Tax credit figures are general; use free VITA tax preparation or a qualified preparer for your situation.

Found Something Out of Date?

Tell your ward or stake self-reliance specialist or your bishop so the next edition can be corrected.

Main Sources

- Social Security Administration (2026 COLA fact sheet; SSDI, SSI, appeals, Compassionate Allowances); NCOA 2026 Medicare Savings Program limits; IRS EITC and Child Tax Credit tables; FCC Lifeline; VA pension rates
- Maryland: Department of Labor UI claimant guide and appeals; Susquehanna Workforce Network; Maryland DHS (SNAP, TCA, TDAP); Maryland Medicaid; DHCD income limits; Maryland Legal Aid eviction guide; OHEP FY27; MSDE Child Care Scholarship; Cecil, Harford and Kent county agency pages; Maryland 211

- Delaware: Division of Unemployment Insurance; DHSS (SNAP, TANF, General Assistance, Medicaid, Purchase of Care, Kinship Care); State Service Centers; Delaware eviction code and right to counsel; Delaware housing authorities; ADRC; Delaware 211
- Pennsylvania: Office of UC benefit guide; DHS (SNAP, TANF, Medical Assistance, LIHEAP, Child Care Works); Pennie; Working Pennsylvanians Tax Credit; PTRR; PHFA 2026 income limits; Lancaster and Chester county agency pages; PA 211
- USDA SNAP FY2027 maximum allotments; 2026 HHS poverty guidelines; H.R. 1 (2025) SNAP and Medicaid changes
- 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline; SAMHSA National Helpline; county crisis services (Eastern Shore Crisis Response, Harford Crisis Response, Delaware Crisis Intervention Services, Lancaster and Chester County Crisis Intervention); Ministry of Caring; Goodwill of Delaware and Delaware County; Chester County OIC